

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in real estate disputes, case and document management, and client-facing legal work. At BCLP's Real Estate Disputes team I prepared hearing bundles, managed matter files across competing deadlines and assisted with court filings. At Citizens Advice I manage a caseload independently from instruction to submission, advising clients on procedural requirements and maintaining accurate, confidential records throughout. Looking to apply that foundation to residential conveyancing, where careful transaction management and clear client communication are central to the role.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules covering dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and governance) — 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Commercial Law, Company Law, Advanced Contract Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with court filings, skeleton arguments and other court materials across several live matters
- Conducted legal and factual research on leasehold issues, rights of light, easements and landlord and tenant disputes
- Maintained matter records in iManage; tracked deadlines and assisted with matter opening, closure and cost comparisons
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across competing matters, keeping files organised and up to date

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions; drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Coordinated documents and tracked outstanding actions ahead of a significant deadline, becoming the only junior supporting the team at that stage
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout
- Liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated with an external translator on Romanian materials
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead**July 2026 – Present****Legal Adviser**

- Manages matters independently from initial client interview through to submission: takes factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Drafts correspondence, prepares document schedules and maintains confidential case records, meeting deadlines throughout
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options across housing, welfare, employment, debt and family matters
- Translates complex rules and processes into clear, practical guidance for clients who are often dealing with their situation for the first time

Q-Legal · London**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the agreed deadline

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report and correspondence drafting; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review and electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Hearing bundle preparation, matter file organisation, deadline tracking, procedural histories, document review across multiple concurrent matters